



OHIO RIVER TRAIL FEASIBILITY STUDY

May 13, 2010 – STEERING COMMITTEE MEETING AGENDA/DISCUSSION POINTS

1. Trail Ownership and Maintenance and Management

2. Plan Preparation Schedule

- Next Meeting – June 17th – Location TBD
- CSX Meeting – Dates and Attendees

3. Proposed Route and Issues/Constraints

TOTAL ROUTE LENGTH OF PROPOSED TRAIL = 17 miles

Section 100 – Monaca Borough to Center Township

On-Road Portion = 1.0 miles

10' Wide Multi Use Path = 1.4 miles

Total Length of Route through Monaca Borough = 2.4 miles

9th Street from Monaca Rochester Bridge to Monaca Memorial Field at Indiana Avenue via 9th Street, Washington Avenue and 16th Street. This segment consists entirely of a signed on-road route. Bicyclists would be required to ride with traffic over the Monaca Rochester Bridge or dismount and walk the bicycle over the bridge via the sidewalk. The sidewalk on the east side of the bridge is 5' wide which requires dismounting for bicyclist. There is a 3' shoulder on the northbound travel lane and a 5' shoulder on the southbound travel lane.

Issues:

1. 9th Street has a higher volume of traffic and periodic speeding was witnessed for vehicles traveling over the bridge into town. There are few locations, especially on the east side of the roadway where there are long curb-cuts which can create conflicts between bicyclists and vehicles entering or leaving the roadway. Traffic calming, curb cut consolidation and enhanced streetscape could be considered for this entire corridor from the bridge to Pennsylvania Avenue. The corridor could also be treated as gateway area, through urban design, landscaping, and gateway treatments on each side of the bridge at the intersection of 9th Street and Atlantic Avenue.

Monaca Memorial Field at Indiana Avenue to Industrial Park Road (Private)/Pennsylvania Avenue Intersection via public alleyway, underneath East Monaca Rochester Bridge, Moor Industrial Park and a public alleyway east of 17th Street

1. It has not been determined if the owners of the Moor Industrial Park will allow a 10' wide easement or outright purchase of right-of-way along the edge of the parcel on the east side of the bridge approach and through a portion of the property (between two apparently vacant building) to reach

Pennsylvania Avenue. It is presumed that a trail could be incorporated into the redevelopment of this site. It is believed that the owners are currently considering redevelopment plans. Ideally this should be codified through modifications to ordinances and the adoption of the trail feasibility study.

Industrial Park Road (Private) from Pennsylvania Avenue Intersection through Beaver Valley Industrial Park to Center Township Line

Issues:

1. The proposed trail would travel along what is today a private roadway that serves the Colona Transfer property, as well as other properties to the east, including CSX's railyard, the coal transfer facility and the Beaver Valley Industrial Park. The point of access near the west approach to the Route 51/Pennsylvania Avenue Bridge over the CSX rail line and the adjacent industrial building is very narrow and has poor site lines. The current proposal would consist of a share the road condition for this area. Ideally the private roadway should be upgraded and made into a public road connection to the proposed upgraded or new Woodlawn Road through the former J&L Steel site in Center Township and the City of Aliquippa. One possible method of solving this issue is to create a new road that would meet Pennsylvania Avenue at a 90 degree angle and straddle the property line between the Moor Industrial Park and the Colona Transfer property. The roadway would travel towards the river and then bend to the east behind the existing building and connect to the existing Industrial Park Road in the vicinity of the Pre-Civil War Cemetery. This alignment would likely be more easily facilitated once the coal transfer facility ceases operation, which could occur sometime in the next few years.
2. Ability to transfer ownership of the Industrial Park Road into a public roadway, including through the gated section through the Beaver Valley Industrial Park to Bet-Tech's parcel currently targeted for a new oil refinery facility.

Section 200 – Center Township to the City of Aliquippa

Total Length of Route through Center Township 10' Wide Multi Use Path = 1.5 miles

Total Length of Route through Hopewell Township (Section 200) 10' Wide Multi Use Path = .06 miles

Total Length of Route through the City of Aliquippa (Section 200) 10' Wide Multi Use Path = 1.6 miles

Borough of Monaca Line to BCED Property at the Eastern Portion of West Aliquippa via Existing or Future Woodlawn Road. The trail would be a continuous 10' wide side path with a 3'-5' wide planted buffer along the railroad side of Woodlawn Road through the entire Section 200.

Issues:

1. The ability to create a 10' wide sidepath along a new roadway from Monaca to Aliquippa appears to be feasible. There is a portion near Elkhorn Run where there is very limited width at the top of slope and the edge of CSX's right-of-way. This is partly due to changes that CSX made to its track alignment

in this area. According to information provided by Richard Dorothy of the CJBettors Corporation, the railroad legal right-of-way agreements in this area, which date back to J&L Steel, are very complicated and open to interpretation. More detailed engineering would be required to determine if a two-lane roadway along with a 10' wide sidepath could be created in this area. There is also an option to locate the trail route at the bottom of the slope, near the edge of the river in this location, but the feasibility of that alignment could only be determined once an engineered alignment between the proposed refinery facility and existing dock is determined. A crossing of the day-lighted portion of Elkhorn Run would be required if this route is chosen.

Section 300 – City of Aliquippa to Hopewell Township

Total Length of Route through the City of Aliquippa (Section 300) 10' Wide Multi Use Path = 3.3 miles

Total Length of Route through Hopewell Township (Section 300) 10' Wide Multi Use Path = .24 miles

BCED Property at the Eastern Portion of West Aliquippa to the Hopewell Township Line Near the Ambridge Aliquippa Bridge via Existing or Future Woodlawn Road. Create a continuous 10' wide side path with a 3'-5' wide planted buffer along the railroad side of Woodlawn Road through the entire Section 300 is proposed.

Issues:

1. The truck traffic volumes and turning movements around the Franklin Avenue underpass could create conflicts between the high volume of truck traffic and bicyclists.
2. The ability to create a public trail along the portions of existing Woodlawn Road from the eastern end of the BCED-Bet-Tech Tin Mill Property would need to be determined. This segment of roadway is currently privately owned. Based on information provided it appears that there are disagreements between private landowners and the municipalities over ownership and maintenance.

Section 400 – Hopewell Township, South Heights Borough and Crescent Township

South Heights Borough On-Road Portion = .1 miles

South Heights Borough 10' Wide Multi Use Path = .9

Total Length of Route through South Heights Borough = 1.0 miles

Crescent Township On-Road Portion = 1.9 miles

Crescent Township 10' Wide Multi Use Path = .2 miles

Total Length of Route through Crescent Township (Section 400) = 2.1 miles

Woodlawn Road/North Street to Power Plant Road Bridge via 10' Wide Path and Signed On-Road Route to Route 51 via Power Plant Road

Power Plant Road to Jeanette Street via 10' Wide Side Path along Reliant Energy Power Plant Parcel Frontage

Jeannette Street to Maple Street at Route 51 via McKae Street, Division Street, Porter Street to Maple Street

Maple Street to Main Street via Signed On-Road Route along Route 51

Route 51 at Main Street to Shouse Park via Main Street and Riverview Road to McCutcheon Way at Shouse Park

Section 400 would be a complex hybrid of a 10' wide multi-use path along the river side of the CSX right-of-way to Power Plant Road, a 10' wide sidepath along the Power Plant's frontage along Route 51 and a signed on-road route for the remainder of the route via Route 51 and local neighborhood streets.

Issues:

1. The ability to acquire CSX property between North Street and Reliant Energy Power Plant will need to be determined.
2. The ability to acquire an easement or right-of-way through Reliant Energy Power Plant and across Power Plant Road Bridge will need to be determined.
3. The need for safety improvements along portions of Route 51, especially for improved crossings at Maple and Main Streets will need to be coordinated with PennDOT and the Township.
4. There is the potential for opposition to bicycle traffic through Crescent Township neighborhoods.
5. There are issue of poor site lines and steep grade at the hair-pin curve on Riverview Road.

Section 500 – Crescent Township to Moon Township

Total Length of On-Road Route through Crescent Township (Section 500) = .2 miles

Moon Township 10' Wide Multi Use Path = 1.7 miles

Moon Township 10' Wide Multi Use Path on Boardwalk = .8 miles

Total Length of Route through Moon Township = 2.5 miles

Shouse Park in Crescent Township to Thorn Run Road in Moon Township via a 10' Wide Path through US Army Corps of Engineers CSX and Moon Township Properties and Duquesne Utility Corridor Property to Moon Township/Coraopolis Borough Line. Section 400 would be a continuous 10' wide side path along the railroad side of ACOE access roadway and a 10' wide multi-use trail (including a boardwalk portion) along the river side of CSX right-of-way to the Moon Township Authority's parcel and on the Route 51 side of the CSX right-of-way to Thorn Run Road.

Issues

1. Dramatic topography along the river creates a narrow shelf to accommodate the railroad right-of-way with limited space for additional facilities. A boardwalk will be required in the area of Stoops Ferry to provide for the width of the trail and to achieve the required setback from the railroad.
2. CSX right-of-way will need to be acquired in the area of Stoops Ferry.

3. The ability to acquire an easement on the Duquesne Power utility corridor will need to be determined including addressing existing landscape/nursery operation located across utility right-of-way in the area of Thorn Run Road.
4. There will need to be utility relocation coordination near the intersection of 4th Avenue and American Bridge Way/Tri State Hose & Supply as well as the creation of a structure to cross Thorn Run.

Section 600 – Moon Township, Coraopolis Borough to Montour Trail Mile Post ‘0’ (Moon Township)

Coraopolis Borough On-Road Portion = 1.2 miles

Coraopolis Borough 10' Wide Multi Use Path = .86 miles

Total Length of Route through Coraopolis Borough = 2.1 miles

Moon Township/Coraopolis Borough Line at Thorn Run Road to Existing Montour Trail Mile Post “0” in Moon Township, via American Bridge Way, 3rd Avenue Right-of-Way (vacant), Watt Street, Birch Way, Kendall Street, 1st Avenue, Broadway, Pine Alley, Montour Street, and the Montour Junction/Sports Legacy Foundation Property. The proposed trail is predominately a signed on-road route through the Borough of Coraopolis with a 10' wide multi-use trail connection at Montour Street to the existing Montour Trail, through the Montour Junction/Sport Legacy Foundation property.

Issues

1. The ownership of the right-of-way for 3rd Avenue between American Bridge and CSX's right-of-way from American Bridge Way to Watt Street needs to be clarified. There is conflicting data regarding the existence of the public right-of-way.
2. Determine if businesses which have frontage along Birch Way still require rear gates for vehicular access. If not, this roadway could be converted into a 10' wide dedicated trail and urban stormwater retention facility.
3. Allegheny County is currently commencing a Community Revitalization Plan for the Borough of Coraopolis. A key component of the ORT Trail through Coraopolis is an on-road green alley route through the downtown, via Pine Alley. Any streetscaping and/or urban design recommendations as part of that effort should incorporate this corridor as an important pedestrian/bicycle spine.
4. Alternative 600B represents a very desirable trail connection along the river's edge. There are several complicated issues with this alternative which make it less desirable as a near-term route, however, opportunities exist to create this route long-term. It is believed that the current owners of Parcel "I" as shown on the Section 600 Routing Plan would like to develop a marina on the site. There are access issues to the property which currently limit their ability to develop the parcel. If a 3rd Avenue as a public roadway could be extended from Chestnut Street to the site, it would provide the access needed for the development of the parcel and allow the creation of a key trail connection through two key parcels along the riverfront. Once access to the potential marina site is achieved, it opens up several additional properties owned by CSX that are not suitable for railroad or other development activities. These parcels could be the location of a new waterfront park creating an

area with parkland on both sides of the Ohio River channel, with Robert Morris University's recreation complex located on the opposite side.